Curriculum Vitae – Francesco Del Prato

Personal Information

Francesco Del Prato

Paris School of Economics
48 Boulevard Jourdan
75014 Paris, France

francesco.delprato@psemail.eu
francescodelprato.github.io
@fdelprato

References

Marc Fleurbaey
Paris School of Economics
48 Bd Jourdan
75014 Paris, France
marc.fleurbaey@psemail.eu

Paolo Zacchia
CERGE-EI
Politických vězňů 7
110 00 Nové Město, Cechia
paolo.zacchia@cerge-ei.cz

Mattia Nardotto
ECARES – Université Libre de Bruxelles
Ave. F.D Roosevelt 42
1050 Brussels, Belgium
mattia.nardotto@ulb.be

Kenan Huremović
IMT School for Advanced Studies
Piazza S. Francesco 19
55100 Lucca, Italy
kenan.huremovic@imtlucca.it

Education

Paris School of Economics *2022-present*
Postdoctoral Fellow

Katholieke Universiteit Leuven *2017-2023*
IMT School for Advanced Studies
(Joint) Ph.D. candidate in Business Economics
Thesis title: "Essays in the Economics of Labor Markets and Retirement Policies"

CERGE-EI – Prague, Czech Republic *2021-2022*
External Research Fellow

Università Commerciale "L. Bocconi" *2014-2017*
MSc in Economics and Social Sciences

Università Commerciale "L. Bocconi" *2011-2014*
BA in Management

Research Fields

Primary Field: Labor Economics

Secondary Fields: Macro-Labor, Productivity, Computational Economics

Working papers

***The Importance of Working for Earnest*: Climbing the Job Ladder through Firms' Connectivity**

Project selected for the VisitINPS 2019 program

Abstract. This paper explores the impact of employers' contributions to reducing on-the-job search frictions on workers' mobility decisions and earnings dynamics. Using a labor market search model, I introduce the idea that firms differ in enhancing their employees' likelihood of receiving external job offers. This shifts search behavior variation from workers to firms. By linking the model's primitives to the per-worker degree centrality of a job-to-job network, I leverage comprehensive administrative data to test three key implications of my model: 1) workers spend less time in more central firms, 2) young workers' initial earnings are lower in more central firms, evidence of a compensating differential, and 3) transitioning out of central firms results in up to a 6% earnings gain, indicating faster career progression. Finally, I structurally estimate this framework on Italian data to quantitatively account for the importance of this channel in explaining earnings dynamics.

The Heterogeneous Consequences of Reduced Labor Costs on Firms Productivity
(joint with Paolo Zacchia)

Project selected for the VisitINPS 2020 program

Abstract. We explore the effect of a reduction in overall labor costs, indirectly induced by an Italian reform that weakened employment protection legislation, on the productivity distribution of manufacturing firms. Due to the unique institutional features of the Italian collective bargaining system, in the manufacturing sector, the reform led to a clean reduction in average worker compensation, without altering the average structure of employment relationships. This decrease in labor cost resulted in a reduction in average total factor productivity (TFP) among less productive firms and an increase at the upper end of the distribution. We pair these findings with increased entry and exit dynamics among low-productivity firms, suggesting the presence of an adverse selection mechanism at the bottom of the TFP distribution, enhanced by the reform. We formalize this concept via a general equilibrium model that links productivity to frictions in the markets for inputs.

Optimal Ramsey Taxation with Social Security
(joint with Marco Francischello and Matteo Paradisi)

Project awarded with a Netspar Comparative Research Grant 2021

Abstract. We develop an OLG model with heterogeneous agents and aggregate uncertainty to study optimal Ramsey taxation when the government can use a credible set of social security instruments. Social security mitigates the income effect in optimal labor tax smoothing and, together with heterogeneity, adds new redistributive motives to both labor and capital taxes while crowding out others. We calibrate the model on three different economies: the US, Netherlands, and Italy. We argue that the three countries would experience heterogeneous gains, in redistributive and efficiency terms, by moving from the status-quo allocations to those prescribed by a utilitarian Ramsey planner. Our simulations show that retirement benefits in the current economies are higher than their Ramsey-optimal level while we argue that the use of funded social security schemes, neglected in current actual policies, could be welfare improving.

Work in progress

Responsible Firms on the Labor Market
(joint with Marc Fleurbaey)

Project selected for the VisitINPS 2023 program

Human Capital Value Chains
(joint with Paolo Zacchia)

Project selected for the VisitINPS 2020 program

Deep Structural Estimation
(joint with Marco Francischello)

Scholarships and awards

VisitINPS Program scholarship (type B) *2023 call*

Netspar Comparative Research Grant *2021*

VisitINPS Program scholarship (type B) *2020 call*

VisitINPS Program scholarship (type B) *2019 call*

Ph.D. Scholarship, KU Leuven *2019*

Full Ph.D. Scholarship, IMT School for Advanced Studies *2017*

Teaching

Microeconometrics (Ph.D.) *Fall 2020-2021*

CERGE-EI, two lectures on random search models and their estimation

Econometrics I *Spring 2019-2020*

IMT School for Advanced Studies, TA for Prof. Paolo Zacchia

Econometrics I *Spring 2018-2019*

IMT School for Advanced Studies, TA for Prof. Paolo Zacchia

Microeconomic Theory (Ph.D.) *Fall 2018-2019*

IMT School for Advanced Studies, TA for Prof. Andrea Canidio and Prof. Kenan Huremovic

Supervising activity *2019-present*

KU Leuven, Master in Business Economics

Seminars and talks

38th AIEL Conference (Genova) *2023*

SOLE 2023 (Philadelphia) *2023*

20th Brucchi Luchino Labor Economic Workshop (Napoli) *2022*

63rd SIE Annual Conference (Torino) *2022*

VisitINPS Seminar (Rome) *2022, 2021*

KU Leuven Doctoral Seminar (Leuven) *2022, 2021*

CERGE-EI lunch Seminar (Prague) *2021*

IMT School Workshop on Technology and Labour Marked (Lucca) *2020*

IT Skills

Programming languages and statistical software:

Stata (data management and reduced-form econometrics)
Python + Numba (simulations, structural model estimation, optimization)
PyTorch (deep learning)
R (reduced-form econometrics, network analysis, basic machine learning)
Matlab (simulations)

Languages

Italian (native), **English** (fluent), **German** (basic)

Professional experience

Camera dei Deputati – Rome, Italy *2015-2018*

Full time personal parliamentary assistant for Mr. Giampaolo Galli, Ph.D.
Policy analysis, public budgetary evaluation, institutional relations

Economics Dept., Università Bocconi – Milan, Italy *2013-2014*

Research assistant for Prof. Nenad Kos
Auction theory, corporate finance